

Instructions for Coursework:

Fundamentals in Personal and Social Competence (EfS)

I. Aim of the Assignment

In Target

Covering all topics predefined (see next page) *.

Keep the target audience of your presentation of the assignment in mind.

Creative

Making a creative & interactive approach.

Creating something unique (USP = Unique Selling Proposition).

What differs your assignment from the other group's assignments?

What is adding extra value for the audiences (in comparison to other groups)?

Professional

Be professional in your approach – this applies both to collaboration and communication within your team and to the preparation and presentation of your coursework.

Teamwork

Work on assignment and prepare presentation as a team (not as a group!).

Sustainable

Contribute to the long-term learning and competence development process. On the one hand, for you and your team members working together on the coursework – but on the other hand, also for your fellow students when you present your results to them and involve them in your work, findings and considerations.

II. Frame for the Assignment

- Calculate and plan to fill 1 h for presenting your coursework in class, including the videos and interactive parts involving the audiences.
(Directly after the presentation you will have a 30 minute feedback session with your lecturer – so in total about 1,5hrs time reserved for your team).
- All team members should share the presentation time equally.
- Be prepared to present not your own culture, but the culture of the other team members.
- The assignment must be prepared in PowerPoint and uploaded in .ppt format (steps I+II).
- Create your own "Team design" for the Power Point slides
- Use the 'Speaker Notes' feature in PowerPoint as a basis for preparing what you want to say in the presentation. Stick to keywords rather than long, complete sentences.
These notes can help you during your actual presentation using the 'speaker view' on your laptop. Alternatively, you can print them out as "notes" to create a handout. This may assist you with your presentation. In addition, this document has also to be printed in Portable Document Format and uploaded as a separate handout in steps I and II as .pdf.
- Plans for interactive parts engaging the audiences, should also be included and uploaded already in Step I in your coursework. Visible either in the presentation and/or only in the handout, so that feedback can also be provided for this part in the feedback meeting.
- Use the .mp4 format for the videos and upload them separately in Step I and Step II.
(as Sciebo does not support embedded videos)
- It is important to ensure that the sound is loud enough so that the videos can be shown in a larger room. Some mobile phone recordings are not loud enough. You may want to use software available online to boost the volume.

- Presentations in class should be done on your own laptop. Then physically insert the videos into the PowerPoint file. Never work with presentations that only contain links in the slides, as there may be problems with the Wi-Fi during the presentations.
- **Always ask questions immediately if anything is unclear**
- **If you think that topics of the coursework or texts of the instruction should be added or changed, make constructive suggestions for changes or improvements.**

III. Content to be covered in your assignment & presentation*

- Ensure that your approach includes a direct comparison of the cultures involved for each aspect and topic of your work so that similarities and differences can be clearly identified and further discussed in direct comparison. For areas where differences and thus potential misunderstandings exist, make suggestions on how best to deal with them.
- Include interactive elements to engage the audiences, supporting their learning process.
- Feel free to change the order of content, if helpful supporting the learning objectives.

1. Title Page

Including relevant information such as names of team members who contributed to the task, title of the presentation and cultures represented in the assignment.

2. Initial situation, key drivers and problem definition

Describe the initial situation and define the problem being addressed with the coursework. Try to formulate 'scientific' questions that you wish to answer with your approach of the coursework.

3. Table of contents

Giving an overview about topics discussed and content, showing the approach to the problem and to answer the problem & questions defined.

4. Overview world map & countries involved

- Show an overview of the world map and countries involved. (Maybe zoom in, if needed)
- Introducing members and where the members are from.
- Maybe giving in your presentation some short additional information about the countries involved as general introduction (as far as relevant in the context of this assignment)

5. Important things to know about the culture for the professional interaction

- Discuss aspects that one should be aware of when dealing with different cultures in a professional context in order to work together successfully, e.g. as a **representative of a company** and negotiating partner or as colleagues working together or as in a relationship employee or employer
(Note: This task is not about covering the aspect of investing in the country!)
- Discuss the impact of specific different cultural rules or cultural related behaviour in various aspects on professional cooperation or negotiation situations.
What is the reason or background for this behaviour?
- Tip: A look at the 'iceberg model' and a joint discussion about it could help to identify relevant topics. (Look beneath the surface!)
- After the discussion in your team, focus for the presentation by **agreeing upon the 3-5 most important aspects** that you consider as **critical success factors or most interesting** in this specific intercultural interaction constellation to go further with, presented and discussed in your coursework.

6. Cultural dimensions of Hofstede

- a) Study at first individually on the cultural dimensions of Hofstede and work on the referring task provided in Moodle (additional source: Hofstede, Geert (2010): Cultures and Organizations - Software of the Mind); <https://www.theculturefactor.com>
 1. Individualism vs. Collectivism
 2. Uncertainty Avoidance
 3. Power Distance
 4. Motivation towards Achievement and Success (former Masculinity vs. Femininity)
 5. Long-term orientation
 6. Indulgence vs. Restraint
- b) Discuss the cultures involved using the individually completed tables (see previous point). On this basis, **agree to cover only four out of the six dimensions in your coursework** – those that you find most insightful for comparison. During the presentation, briefly explain why you chose these four and not the other two.
- c) Create a scheme of visualization for the four selected cultural dimensions that can optimally represent the core messages graphically to be integrated in your slides for the presentation. Each cultural dimension should be considered separately. You can use Excel for this, but you can also find other creative means of visualisation. This graphic representation should not only reflect your personal perception, but best step by step integrates the other assessments (see next points). So that you can gradually create a comprehensive comparison integrating different aspects - that is easy to understand and visually supports what you are saying in your presentation in class.
- d) Explain in your presentation, why you perceive your culture the way you do. (Give two specific examples from everyday life that illustrate your assessment)
- e) In addition to your personal view, add Hofstede's results to your graphical visualization <https://www.theculturefactor.com> ; see chapter 'country comparison tool' provided on the page and study his argumentation coming to this assessment.
- f) Also indicate whether you agree with Hofstede's findings. Why or why not? Critically discuss: What might be problems with his approach? What might be problems with your approach?
- g) In addition, based on the same cultural dimensions chosen, discuss how you perceive Rhine-Waal University organizational and work culture; focusing on academic staff and administration and not on students. Give two specific examples to support your assumptions. Since there is no official Hofstede score, add the German graph to compare your perception of HSRW with Hofstede research findings for Germany.
- h) Conclude and discuss the implications when these cultures involved come together in a professional context (at our university). If there are areas where potential problems or misunderstandings may arise. Discuss and make suggestions how best to deal with them.

7. Culture and Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

- a) **Choose 3 out of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** and discuss how the cultures involved are having impact on reaching the sustainable goals. What aspects of these cultures might be supporting - what might be hindering factors? Why?
- b) Link in your discussion – in case of being supportive - the insights you have gained from the Hofstede part. But for sure there are additional aspects that might have to be integrated. Back your argumentation if possible with other sources/ research findings.
- c) Speculate: Can the SDGs influence these cultures in the medium to long term? How?

8. Videos comparing culture in concrete scenarios

- a) As example for producing your videos, please watch the Chinese-German comparing videos (see Moodle course page)
- b) Save the videos for last thing to do in your coursework, because once you have explored the other topics in depth, the scenarios you compare in your videos can incorporate many more aspects and thus contribute much more to the learning process on all sides.
- c) Create videos in the form seen in the example videos comparing the cultures - but in your case show relationship & cooperation in a professional setting dealing with SDGs related controversial views or potential conflicts dealing with SDG related topics:
Scenario 1: same hierarchy (e.g. showing colleagues or negotiation partners interaction)
Scenario 2: different hierarchy (showing boss-employee interaction)
=> **meaning in total 4 videos** (2 from each cultural cluster)
- d) Each video should be no longer than 2 Minutes
- e) It is best to create the videos altogether in your team and in your native language (adding subtitles), as the situation and body language will appear much more natural than in English (unless this is not in line with your usual professional working culture you wish to present). If there are not enough members from the culture in question, try to recruit external volunteers for the videos or train team members to represent this culture.
- f) Starting the video part in your presentation by giving an overview what the scenario comparing is going to be about
- g) Presenting in class include the videos physically into the slides (a link might sometimes not work if there are problems with the WLAN). For each of the four videos a separate slide.
- h) Concluding the video part of your presentation in the end explaining what you intended to show with the videos? What were the learning objectives to be demonstrated?

9. Summarization conclusion and outlook

Summarize the key points and findings of the assignment presented (Linking to the initial problem and scientific question you started your work with in your coursework).

Finalize your presentation by giving a conclusion and maybe as well outlook and/or appeal to the audiences.